

IDEATION PHASE

Empathize & Discover — Empathy Map Canvas

Date	4 August 2026
Project Name	Online Complaint Registration System (MERN Stack)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

An empathy map captures what a user thinks, feels, hears, sees, says, and does, helping the team design around real frustrations and goals rather than assumptions. Since Online Complaint Registration serves two primary user types with very different needs, empathy maps were created for both the Citizen and the Officer.

Empathy Map — Citizen (Online Complaint Registration)

WHAT DOES THEY THINK AND FEEL? • Worried the complaint won't be taken seriously. • Hopes for a quick resolution. • Frustrated by lack of updates.	WHAT DOES THEY SEE? • Long queues at government offices. • Other apps with confusing complaint forms. • Social media posts about unresolved civic issues.
WHAT DOES THEY HEAR? • Neighbors complain about unresolved issues. • Officials say 'we'll look into it'. • Friends suggest posting on social media instead.	WHAT DOES THEY SAY AND DO? • Calls the helpline repeatedly. • Visits the office in person. • Posts on social media to get attention.
PAIN • Hard to know if a complaint was received. • No visibility into resolution progress. • Feels ignored after filing.	GAIN • Instant confirmation of complaint filing. • Real-time status tracking. • Trust that issues get resolved.

Empathy Map — Officer (Online Complaint Registration)

WHAT DOES THEY THINK AND FEEL? • Wants to resolve issues efficiently. • Frustrated by scattered, untracked complaints. • Concerned about missing deadlines.	WHAT DOES THEY SEE? • Piles of paper complaint forms. • Citizens following up in person or by phone. • Other departments using digital tools.
WHAT DOES THEY HEAR? • Supervisors asking for status updates. • Citizens complaining about delays. • Colleagues discussing backlog.	WHAT DOES THEY SAY AND DO? • Manually logs complaints in a register/spreadsheet. • Calls citizens to clarify complaint details. • Reports status verbally to supervisors.

PAIN

- No centralized queue of assigned complaints.
- Time lost on manual logging and follow-up.
- No easy way to track resolution history.

GAIN

- Automated complaint queue, prioritized by urgency.
- More time for on-ground resolution.
- Clear record of actions taken.

Key Takeaways

- Citizens need transparency and fast acknowledgment when filing complaints.
- Officers need an organized system to manage and resolve complaints without manual tracking.
- Both personas value a shared, real-time system, reinforcing the need for a single, role-based MERN platform rather than separate manual processes.